



The 12-Point Production Risk Checklist

Review your production plan before you commit capital.

Your next production order is not a creative decision. It is a financial one.

Every unchecked detail — factory capacity, costing accuracy, timeline integrity — becomes your responsibility the moment capital is committed. This checklist is designed to surface production risk before it becomes expensive.

FACTORY & SUPPLIER VERIFICATION

— 01

Have you independently verified your factory's production capacity for your order size?

Factories accept orders beyond capacity. When they do, production is delayed, outsourced to subcontractors you have not vetted, or rushed at the expense of quality.

— 02

Do you have a written record of your factory's current client load and lead times?

Your order is one of many. Without knowing where you sit in their queue, your timeline is based on assumption — not priority.

— 03

Have you vetted your factory beyond samples?

Sample quality does not reflect bulk production. Different teams, workflows, and incentives govern each stage. A strong sample does not guarantee a strong delivery.

TIMELINE & MILESTONE ACCOUNTABILITY

— 07

Do you have a production calendar with defined milestone dates — not just a delivery target?

A delivery date without milestones is not a plan. It is a risk.

— 08

Have you confirmed raw material availability and lead times before committing to your timeline?

Most delays originate before production begins. Fabric and trims that were assumed available often are not.

— 09

Do you have a contingency plan if a milestone slips by more than one week?

If your backup plan is reactive, it is already expensive.

COSTING & MARGIN PROTECTION

— 04

Have you broken down your factory's quote line by line — fabric, trims, labor, finishing, packing?

Lump-sum quotes conceal margin erosion. If you cannot trace each cost, you cannot verify the accuracy of the total.

— 05

Have you confirmed your landed cost including shipping, duties, and import fees?

Factory cost is not product cost. Most brands lose margin in the gap between the two.

— 06

Have you stress-tested your retail price against actual total cost — not projected cost?

Pricing built on estimates fails when invoices arrive. If your margin only works on projection, it does not work.

PRE-PRODUCTION RISK REVIEW

— 10

Has your tech pack been reviewed for production readiness by someone other than your factory?

Factories execute what is given. Ambiguity becomes error, and error becomes cost.

— 11

Has your production plan been reviewed by someone who has managed orders at your scale?

Risk increases with scale. Decisions that are manageable at lower volumes compound quickly as capital increases.

— 12

Can you clearly answer “what happens if this goes wrong?” for each major production decision?

If the answer is unclear, the risk is currently yours.

If You Cannot Answer These Clearly

Production risk is already present.

Most mistakes are not unpredictable. They are simply unreviewed.

NEXT STEP

If you are preparing to place a production order and want this reviewed before capital is committed:

➤ **Schedule a Production Risk Assessment**

oceoluxe.com